

Coq au Vin

Ingredients

250gms bacon slices
20 pearl onions, peeled, or 1 large yellow onion, sliced
1,5kg chicken thighs and legs, excess fat trimmed, skin ON
6 garlic cloves, peeled
Salt and pepper to taste
2 cups chicken stock
2 cups red wine (pinot noir, burgundy, or zinfandel)
2 bay leaves
Several fresh thyme sprigs
Several fresh parsley sprigs
250gms button mushrooms, trimmed and roughly chopped
2 Tbsp butter
Chopped fresh parsley for garnish

Method

Step 1:

Brown bacon on medium high heat in a dutch oven big enough to hold the chicken, about 10 minutes. Remove the cooked bacon, set aside. Keep the bacon fat in the pan. Working in batches if necessary, add onions and chicken, skin side down. Brown the chicken well, on all sides, about 10 minutes.

Step 2:

Halfway through the browning, add the garlic and sprinkle the chicken with salt and pepper. (Note: it is best to add salt while cooking, not just at the very end. It brings out the flavor of the chicken.)

Step 3:

Spoon off any excess fat. Add the chicken stock, wine, and herbs. Add back the bacon. Lower heat to a simmer. Cover and cook for 20 minutes, or until chicken is tender and cooked through. Remove chicken and onions to a separate platter. Remove the bay leaves, herb sprigs, garlic, and discard.

Step 4:

Add mushrooms to the remaining liquid and turn the heat to high. Boil quickly and reduce the liquid by three fourths until it becomes thick and saucy. Lower the heat, stir in the butter. Return the chicken and onions to the pan to reheat and coat with sauce. Adjust seasoning. Garnish with parsley and serve.

THE
COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

The Colony Shopping Centre, 345 Jan Smuts Avenue, Craighall, 2024.

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Quick Bouef Bourguignon

Ingredients

900 gms chuck steak, cut into 2-3cm pieces
1 cup dry red wine
1/2 cup beef stock
2 carrots, sliced 1/2 cm thick
3 slices of bacon
225 gms fresh mushrooms, quartered
2 tbs. flour
12 small pearl onions or 1 large onion, chopped
1/4 tsp. basil
2 cloves garlic, minced

Method

Step 1:

Slice bacon into 1 cm pieces and fry in cooker. Add onion and cook for 2 minutes.

Step 2:

Add steak and brown meat for 5 minutes be careful to not over crowd the pressure cooker.

Step 3:

Stir in flour and blend thoroughly. Stir in wine, beef stock and seasonings. Close the lid.

Step 4:

Cook for 25 minutes. Remove the lid.

Step 5:

Add carrots and mushrooms and simmer with the lid until done, about 15-20 minutes, if needed add a little stock if the gravy is too thick

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Moules Marinieres

Ingredients

2 tablespoons unsalted butter
1 small leek, white and light green parts only, thinly sliced
1 small shallot, thinly sliced
4 medium cloves garlic, thinly sliced
2 bay leaves
Coarse salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 cup hard dry cider or white wine
1kg mussels, cleaned
2 to 3 tablespoons heavy cream
1 tablespoon juice and 1 teaspoon grated zest from 1 lemon
3 tablespoons minced fresh parsley leaves
Additional homemade mayonnaise for serving (optional, see note above)
1 loaf rustic sourdough bread, thickly sliced, drizzled with olive oil, and broiled until heavily toasted

Method

Step 1:

Melt 1 tablespoon butter in a large saucepan over medium-low heat. Add leeks, shallot, garlic, and bay leave. Season lightly with salt and heavily with black pepper and cook, stirring, until vegetables are very soft but not browned, about 10 minutes.

Step 2:

Increase heat to high and add cider or wine. Bring to a boil and let reduce by half, about 2 minutes. Add mussels, stir, cover, and cook, shaking pan constantly and peeking every 30 seconds to stir. As soon as all the mussels are open, transfer mussels to a bowl using tongs. Place pan lid over bowl to keep mussels warm.

Step 3:

Remove from heat and whisk in remaining butter along with heavy cream. Return mussels to pot, add parsley, lemon juice, and lemon zest, stir to combine, then transfer to a warm serving bowl. Serve immediately.

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Pâté de foie de poulet

Ingredients

225gms chicken livers, well-trimmed
1/2 small onion, thinly sliced
1 small garlic clove, smashed and peeled
1 bay leaf
1/4 teaspoon thyme leaves
fine salt
120ml light chicken stock
175gms unsalted butter, at room temperature
2 teaspoons Cognac or Scotch whisky
Freshly ground pepper

Method

Step 1

In a medium saucepan, combine the chicken livers, onion, garlic, bay leaf, thyme and 1/2 teaspoon of salt. Add the stock/water and bring to a simmer.

Step 2:

Cover, reduce the heat to low and cook, stirring occasionally, until the livers are barely pink inside, about 3 minutes. Remove from the heat and let stand, covered, for 5 minutes.

Step 3:

Discard the bay leaf. Using a slotted spoon, transfer the livers, onion and garlic to a food processor; process until coarsely pureed. With the machine on, add the butter, 2 tablespoons at a time, until incorporated.

Step 4:

Add the Cognac, season with salt and pepper and process until completely smooth. Scrape the pâté into 2 or 3 large ramekins. Press a piece of plastic wrap directly onto the surface of the pâté and refrigerate until firm.

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Pot au chocolat

Ingredients

270 gms high-quality semisweet chocolate, chopped
1 1/2 cups whole milk
1 1/2 cups heavy cream
6 large egg yolks
5 tablespoons granulated sugar (add an extra tablespoon if using bitter chocolate)
1/4 teaspoon salt
1 tablespoon confectioners' sugar

Directions

Step 1

Place the chocolate in a blender. Whisk the milk, 1 cup cream, egg yolks, granulated sugar and salt in a heavy-bottomed medium saucepan over medium heat. Cook, stirring constantly with a heatproof spatula, until the mixture is thick enough to coat the spatula and almost boiling, 5 to 6 minutes.

Step 2:

Immediately pour the milk mixture over the chocolate in the blender. Cover and hold the lid with a thick kitchen towel; blend until combined and smooth, stopping to scrape down the sides of the blender as needed. Divide the chocolate mixture among ramekins or small cups and refrigerate until set, about 2 hours.

Step 3:

Whip the remaining 1/2 cup cream and the confectioners' sugar with a mixer or in the blender until soft peaks form. Top the chilled pots de creme with whipped cream.

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QUICHE LORRAINE

INGREDIENTS

For the pastry

175g plain flour

100g cold butter, cut into pieces

1 egg yolk

METHOD

Step 1:

For the pastry, put the flour, butter, egg yolk and 4 tsp cold water into a food processor. Using the pulse button, process until the mix binds. Tip the pastry onto a lightly floured surface, gather into a smooth ball, then roll out as thinly as you can. Line a 23 x 25cm loose-bottomed, fluted flan tin, easing the pastry into the base. Trim the pastry edges with scissors (save any trimmings) so it sits slightly above the tin (if it shrinks, it shouldn't now go below the level of the tin). Press the pastry into the flutes, lightly prick the base with a fork, then chill for 10 mins. Put a baking sheet in the oven and heat oven to 200C/fan 180C/gas 6.

Step 2

Line pastry case with foil, shiny side down, fill with dry beans and bake on the hot sheet for 15 mins. Remove foil and beans and bake for 4-5 mins more until the pastry is pale golden. If you notice any small holes or cracks, patch up with pastry trimmings. You can make up to this point a day ahead. While the pastry cooks, prepare the filling.

INGREDIENTS

For the filling

200g pack lardon, unsmoked or smoked

50g Gruyère

200ml carton crème fraîche

200ml double cream

3 eggs well beaten

pinch ground nutmeg

METHOD

Heat a small frying pan, tip in the lardons and fry for a couple of mins. Drain off any liquid that comes out, then continue cooking until the lardons just start to colour, but aren't crisp. Remove and drain on paper towels. Cut three quarters of the cheese into small dice and finely grate the rest. Scatter the diced cheese and fried lardons over the bottom of the pastry case.

Step 4

Using a spoon, beat the crème fraîche to slacken it then slowly beat in the double cream. Mix in the beaten eggs. Season (you shouldn't need much salt) and add nutmeg. Pour three-quarters of the filling into the pastry case.

Step 5

Half-pull the oven shelf out and put the flan tin on the baking sheet. Quickly pour the rest of the filling into the pastry case – you get it right to the top this way. Scatter the grated cheese over the top, then carefully push the shelf back into the oven. Lower the oven to 190C/fan 170C/gas 5. Bake for about 25 mins, or until golden and softly set (the centre should not feel too firm). Let the quiche settle for 4-5 mins, then remove from the tin. Serve freshly baked, although it's also good cold.

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Dauphinoise Potatoes

Ingredients

500ml double cream

500ml milk

3 garlic cloves

8 large King Edward or Maris Piper potatoes

100g Gruyère cheese (optional)

Method

Step 1

Tip the cream, milk and garlic into a large saucepan and bring to a simmer.

Step 2

Slice the potatoes very finely, about 3-4mm, add them to the cream and simmer for 3 mins until just cooked. Gently stir to separate the potato and stop it sinking and catching on the bottom of the pan.

Step 3

Remove the potatoes with a slotted spoon and place in a wide shallow ovenproof dish so that they are about 5cm in depth. Pour over the garlic infused cream (discarding the garlic) – just enough to seep through the layers and leave a little moisture on the surface.

Step 4

Scatter over the cheese, if using, then bake for 30 mins until the potatoes are soft and browned – increase the heat for 5 mins if not brown enough.

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BISTRO SALAD WITH GOATS CHEESE CROUTES

INGREDIENTS

240gms goat cheese log (fresh chèvre-style goat cheese)
1/2 cup panko or bread crumbs (chilled)
1 tablespoon vegetable oil
6 cups lettuce (tender lettuces such as spring mix, butter lettuce, or oak leaf lettuce)
3 tablespoons extra virgin olive oil
1 tablespoon good quality red wine vinegar
1/4 teaspoon ground mustard
1 dash fine sea salt
1 dash freshly ground black pepper

METHOD

Step 1: Cut the goat cheese into 8 to 10 disks. Put the panko or bread crumbs into a shallow bowl. If you will be baking the goat cheese croutes, mix the vegetable oil in with the panko. Heat the oven to 180C if you will be baking the goat cheese croutes.

Step 2: For either preparation, press the goat cheese disks into the panko. Flip the disks to make sure both sides are completely covered and roll the edges through the panko as well. Set the coated goat cheese on a baking sheet or platter. Place the platter in the freezer for 15 to 30 minutes. This allows the croutes to set prior to cooking.

Step 3: While the goat cheese sets, tear the lettuce into bite-size pieces, wash and dry the lettuce, and set aside. If you are using herbs in addition to lettuce, wash, dry, and prepare them for the salad.

Step 4: In a large salad bowl, whisk together the olive oil, vinegar, and mustard. Add salt and pepper to taste and add the clean lettuce to the bowl.

Step 5: If cooking on the stove, heat the vegetable oil in a large frying pan over medium-high heat. Add the goat cheese rounds. Cook, without disturbing, until they're brown on one side. Flip them over and cook until they're brown on the second side. Remove them from the heat and drain them on a paper towel-lined plate.

Step 6: Toss the salad gently to coat the lettuce thoroughly with the dressing. Divide the salad between four salad plates. Top each salad with 2 or 3 goat cheese croutes and serve immediately.

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AVOCADO & ROMAINE SALAD

Light, quick and fresh!

SALAD

INGREDIENTS

1 cup cherry tomatoes (halved)
1 tablespoon chives (fresh, chopped)
1 1/3 cup avocado (chopped)
3 cups romaine hearts (chopped)
2 teaspoons parsley (chopped)
1 teaspoon dill (chopped)
Drizzle balsamic vinegar (to taste)
Drizzle extra virgin olive oil (to taste)

METHOD

Step 1: PREPARE THE INGREDIENTS; start by cutting tomatoes, roughly chop the chives, parsley, and dill, add everything to a bowl. Roughly chop the romaine lettuce and add to the bowl, toss gently and season with a little salt and pepper, place in a serving platter

Step 2: Gently peel the avocados, and cut into rough chunks and add these to the tomato and lettuce salad.

SALAD DRESSING

INGREDIENTS

2 tbsp red wine vinegar
6 tbsp extra virgin olive oil

METHOD

Step 1: PREPARE THE SALAD DRESSING: Whisk together the olive oil and vinegar, season with a little salt & pepper, drizzle over the prepared salad.

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PROVENÇAL OLIVE TAPENADE

Intense and loaded with flavour!

INGREDIENTS

1/2 cup pitted black olives, such as Niçoise or oil-cured olives
1 tablespoon drained capers
2 drained oil-packed anchovy fillets
3 medium cloves garlic
5 basil leaves (optional)
1 tablespoon loosely packed fresh oregano, marjoram, or thyme leaves
1 teaspoon Dijon mustard
1 teaspoon fresh juice from 1 lemon
Extra-virgin olive oil, as needed

METHOD

If using a food processor: Combine olives, capers, anchovies, garlic, basil (if using), other herbs, and mustard in the work bowl and process, scraping down the sides, until a finely chopped paste forms. Process in lemon juice. With the processor running, drizzle in just enough olive oil to loosen to a spreadable paste, about 2 tablespoons. Season with salt and pepper only if needed.

If using a mortar and pestle: Roughly chop olives, capers, anchovies, and garlic, then add to mortar with basil (if using) and other herbs. Tap, crush, and smash with pestle until ingredients have been reduced to a thick paste (a little chunkiness is okay). Using pestle, work in mustard and lemon juice, then drizzle in just enough olive oil to form a spreadable paste, about 2 tablespoons. Season with salt and pepper only if needed.

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GRUYERE GOUGERES

Delicious light cheesy puffs!

INGREDIENTS

5tbsp butter
1 teaspoon salt
1/4 teaspoon fresh ground black pepper
1/4 teaspoon freshly ground nutmeg
1 cup water, plus 1/2 teaspoon water, divided
1 cup all-purpose flour
1 cup grated gruyere cheese
5 large eggs, at room temperature (very important)

METHOD

Step 1:

Add butter, salt, pepper and nutmeg to 1 cup water in a medium saucepan and bring to a boil over medium-high heat.

Step 2: When butter melts, reduce the heat to low.

Step 3: Add flour to saucepan all at once and beat with a wooden spoon over low heat for about a minute until mixture pulls away from sides of the pan.

Step 4: Remove pan from heat.

Step 5: Add cheese to pan and beat with wooden spoon until thoroughly mixed.

Step 6: Add 4 eggs, one at a time, beating each into the batter until well mixed before adding the next.

Step 7: Continue beating mixture until it is smooth, shiny and firm.

Step 8: Now in a frying pan heat sufficient oil to deep fry small balls, until 140C

Step 9: Now carefully fry small tsp size balls of batter until puffed up and golden and cooked through, remove with a slotted spoon and drain on paper towel, sprinkle with salt and serve warm

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Fricassee of green bean

Ingredients

300g green beans
2 shallot, finely sliced
1/2 clove garlic
pinch dry red chilli
small knob of butter
dash olive oil

Instructions

Step 1:

For the beans, bring a pan of water to the boil, add the green beans and simmer for four minutes. Prepare a bowl of ice cold water.

Step 2:

Remove the beans from the heat, drain and briefly place into the cold water. Drain again.

Step 3:

In a pan, lightly fry the shallot in a little oil and add the green beans. Season to taste with salt and freshly ground black pepper.

Step 4:

Serve the beef with the sauce, bean fricassee and champ.

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PORK TENDERLOIN WITH APPLES & SAGE

INGREDIENTS

700gms boneless pork tenderloin
1-2 tbsp olive oil
2 tsp chopped sage
salt and pepper
1 Gala apple core removed and cut into chunks
with the skin on
1/2 a yellow onion diced
2 tbsp balsamic vinegar
1 cup apple jam

METHOD

Step 1:

Preheat the oven to 180C. Heat 1 tablespoon of olive oil in a cast-iron skillet over high heat. Carefully place the pork tenderloin into the pan and cook each side for approximately 3 to 4 minutes, or until each side is nicely browned.

Step 2:

Lower the heat to medium-low. Remove the tenderloin from the pan, temporarily placing it on a plate. Add a generous pinch of salt to both sides of the tenderloin, as well as a small pinch of freshly ground pepper; set aside.

Step 3:

To the pan, add another tablespoon of oil (if needed). Add the apple chunks and diced onion. Give everything a stir and sauté for a couple of minutes until the onions turn translucent. Pour in 1 tablespoon of balsamic vinegar and again stir everything together. Remove the skillet from the heat.

Step 4:

Gently push aside the apple chunks and onions to clear a space in the middle of the pan for the pork tenderloin. Transfer the tenderloin back into the pan, pouring its residual juices on the plate in as well.

Step 5:

Warm the apple jam for 30 seconds in the microwave, then add a tablespoon of balsamic vinegar to it. Stir in the vinegar until its incorporated, then smear the jam all over the pork tenderloin. Sprinkle the chopped sage over the entire contents of the pan.

Step 6:

Cover the skillet with a sheet of foil, then bake the tenderloin for 20 minutes, stopping to remove the sheet of foil. Bake for another 10 to 20 minutes, until it registers at least 165°F on a meat thermometer. Once it's done baking, let the tenderloin rest for at least 5 minutes before slicing on the diagonal and serving.

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Ratafia & Honey Glazed Carrots

Ingredients

120g Butter, Divided
6 Carrots, Peeled And Cut Into Thick Circles
1/4-1/5 cup Ratafia
1/3 cup honey
Half teaspoon (to 1 Teaspoon) Salt
Freshly Ground Pepper, to taste
Chives

Method

Melt 1 tablespoon butter in a large skillet over high heat. Add carrots in two batches, cooking for 60-90 seconds each batch. Remove from skillet.

Pour in brandy and allow to evaporate 30 seconds. Reduce heat to medium, and add remaining butter. When butter melts, sprinkle brown sugar over the top. Stir together, then add carrots to skillet. Cover, and continue cooking for 5 minutes.

Remove lid and add salt and pepper. Continue cooking until carrots are done and glaze is thick, about 5 more minutes.

Pour onto a platter and serve immediately. Sprinkle with chopped chives if desired.

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TARTE AU CITRON

Pâte Sucrée

220 g flour , plain/all purpose
50 g soft icing sugar / powdered sugar , sifted
15 g almond meal / ground almonds
1/4 tsp salt
100g / 7 tbsp butter , unsalted, softened, cut into 1cm cubes
1 large egg , at room temperature

Curd Filling

1 tbsp lemon zest (1 lemon's worth)
125 ml lemon juice (from 1 – 2 lemons)
150 g white sugar
170 g unsalted butter , cut in 1cm (1/2") cubes
3 whole eggs large,
3 egg yolks (from large-size eggs,

Method: Pâte Sucrée

Step 1: Place all the dry ingredients in the bowl of a food processor.

Step 2: Add the cold butter and pulse until the butter is incorporated. Now add the whole egg and run the machine until the dough starts to come together.

Step 3: Gather the dough and wrap in clingwrap, shape into a 2cm thick disc, place in the freezer for 10 minutes

Step 4: Remove the pastry from the freezer and on a lightly floured surface roll out until 3mm thick.

Step 5: Transfer the pastry to your baking tin and gently ease it into the sides, do not stretch the pastry as this will cause shrinking. Dock the pastry thoroughly to avoid the pastry from rising. Place the pastry shell in the freezer for 10 minutes.

Step 6: Remove from the freezer add a sheet of baking paper and fill with baking beans place in the preheated oven to 200°C / 390°F (180°C fan). Bake for 15 minutes then remove the beans and baking paper and bake for a further 10-minutes until the base is lightly golden. Remove from the oven and allow to cool completely before filling, this will keep the crust nice and crisp.

LEMON TART FILLING:

Preheat oven: Preheat oven to 180°C

Step 1: Whisk ingredients together: Put all ingredients in a medium saucepan and whisk to combine.

Step 2: Thicken on stove: Place the saucepan on the stove over low / medium low heat. Whisk constantly, especially as the butter is melting, to ensure it doesn't split. Keeping stirring until the mixture thickens enough to visibly mound (ie. holds its shape briefly) on the surface when dolloped – about 5 minutes, though it might take longer depending on stove strength, saucepan heat retention etc.

Strain into a bowl using a fine mesh strainer.

Fill tart: Pour into tart shell and smooth the filling surface using an offset spatula or similar.

Bake: Bake for 5 minutes. It will still be a soft custard when you touch it but not liquidity. It will set more when cooled so it's sliceable.

Allow to cool completely before cutting as this will allow the tart to firm up.

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POTATO & LEEK SOUP

INGREDIENTS

3 tablespoons unsalted butter

4 large leeks, white and light green parts only, roughly chopped (about 5 cups)

3 cloves garlic, peeled and smashed

900g potatoes, peeled and roughly chopped into ½-inch pieces

7 cups chicken or vegetable stock

2 bay leaves

3 sprigs fresh thyme

1 teaspoon salt

¼ teaspoon ground black pepper

1 cup heavy cream

Chives, finely chopped, for serving

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Melt the butter over medium heat in a large soup pot. Add the leeks and garlic and cook, stirring regularly, until soft and wilted, about 10 minutes. Adjust the heat as necessary so as not to brown.

Step 2: Add the potatoes, broth, bay leaves, thyme, salt and pepper to pot and bring to a boil. Cover and turn the heat down to low. Simmer for 15 minutes, or until the potatoes are very soft.

Step 3: Fish out the thyme sprig and bay leaves, then purée the soup with a hand-held immersion blender until smooth. (Alternatively, use a standard blender to purée the soup in batches; see note.) Add the heavy cream and bring to a simmer. Taste and adjust seasoning with salt and pepper. If soup is too thin, simmer until thickened. If it's too thick, add water or stock to thin it out. Garnish with fresh herbs if desired.

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French Meatballs in the Dijon style

Ingredients

700 gms ground beef
Salt and freshly ground black pepper to taste
1 cup parsley/thyme/sage leaves, finely minced
2 minced garlic cloves
1 egg
1/2 cup vegetable oil
1 cup finely minced onion (about 1/2 large onion)
1/2 cup dry white wine
3 tablespoons Dijon mustard
1 1/2 cups heavy cream

Method

Step 1

In a mixing bowl, we combined the beef, salt and pepper, parsley garlic and egg. We mixed it all well together and shaped the meat into 12 meatballs.

Step 2

In heavy pan, heat the vegetable oil over medium-high heat until the vegetable oil shimmers. We cooked the meatballs, about 3 minutes on each side, until they were light brown. The meatballs won't stick to the pan, because you're using so much oil (and more fat will be rendered from the meatballs). Fortunately, most of that fat gets poured off.

Step 3

Once the meatballs are browned off remove and add keep warm

Step 4

Once all the meatballs are cooked, remove most of the oil from the pan then add the finely chopped onion. Let the onions cook over medium heat until tender, but not brown, about 3 minutes. Then add the wine and let it all simmer and cook down a bit.

Step 5

Now whisk in the Dijon mustard once it is amalgamated whisk in the cream, and then add back the meatballs. Cook the meatballs in the cream over medium heat, uncovered, about 5 minutes, or until the cream had reduced by about 1/3. Cover the pan and simmer on a low flame until the meatballs are cooked through.

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